



When Apple moves into your city

Demystifying the Apple Store blueprint in India

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Apple has cut the ribbons. With Koregaon Park in Pune and Hebbal in Bengaluru now open to the public, those iconic glass doors are no longer a rumour or a render, they're here, buzzing with curious students, tech workers, families, and the odd selfie brigade. An Apple Store is really a city-level project. It is part theatre, part classroom, part distribution node, and part signal to the market that the brand is here to play a long game.

But the more interesting question is: what does it really mean when an Apple Store lands in your city in 2025? If Mumbai and Delhi taught us anything over the past two years, it's that an Apple Store isn't just a retail touchpoint. It's a switch that flips something

larger in a city's economy, culture, and buying behaviour.

The economic engine

Look back at BKC and Saket, and you see why malls fight to land Apple. In their first full year, those two stores notched up over Rs 600 crore in revenue, with some reports putting it closer to Rs 800 crore, making it one of the fastest retail scale-ups of any brand in India. For Apple, that's just one piece of the puzzle. The halo effect boosted sales across online and authorised resellers in NCR and MMR, helping Apple revenue cross \$8 billion.

Pinpointing that halo effect is tricky, but tech analyst and market insights expert Yogesh Brar told me the uplift is real: "In the Mumbai and the NCR

region, I have observed a regional sales uplift of approximately 15–20% across all channels in the quarters following the store launches. Anecdotally, traffic to Apple's India online store from IP addresses in Mumbai and NCR saw a sustained spike of nearly 25% post-launch."

The fear that official stores would cannibalise reseller business never materialised. As Brar put it: "Resellers in high-traffic areas near the official stores reported a significant increase in footfall, with many consumers coming in with purchase decisions already made, effectively turning those resellers into fulfillment centers." Kailash Lakhyani, Founder Chairman of AIMRA, agreed: "The opening of new Apple stores tends to increase customer traffic across all sales channels... Their primary purpose is to serve a specific type of customer: those who prefer to buy from an official, company-owned store for the unique experience and prestige it offers."

The formula is straightforward, and there's a reason mall developers treat Apple like an anchor tenant. It doesn't discount, it doesn't hard sell, but it keeps the experience spotless and quietly pulls heavy footfall across the week. As Faisal Kawoosa, Chief Analyst & Founder of Techarc put it: "Once a customer enters into any Apple store, it's very unlikely that the person will leave empty hands. Even if the person would not have made up the mind, the sheer magic of Apple stores definitely converts into sales."

Expect the same in Hebbal and Koregaon Park. In Bengaluru, you've got a tech workforce with both the income and the appetite for high-ASP devices. In Pune, it's a city thick with students, creators, and upwardly mobile professionals and is the perfect mix for iPhones bought on EMI and Macs bought as "investments."

As IDC's Associate Vice President Navkendar Singh points out, around seven out of ten iPhones in India now move through some kind of financing